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The Global Connection: [SDG 6](#), Clean water and Sanitation connect with Indigenous water rights because, firstly, everyone deserves clean water, and Canada is one of the wealthiest countries in the world. Why is it mostly Indigenous people who don't get clean water? The reason is environmental racism. How exactly does environmental racism create a barrier to clean water and sanitation? [Environmental Racism creates barriers through different governments, funding, or corporate decisions/policies, making indigenous communities lose their reliable source of water or never have had it.](#) The Canadian Government also have forcibly relocated indigenous people onto reserves where the government allowed environmentally harmful facilities, such as landfills, processing plants, and more. This leads to environmental disasters, and all these policies have harmed water sources in indigenous territories. Clean water should be for everyone; the fact that indigenous people need to fight for it is wrong. [More than 800 million people, who were indigenous people and traditional groups, lived without clean water and sanitation.](#) They had to travel long distances to get clean water, which the task normally fell on women and children, which wasn't safe for them. They tried to fix the loss of control of ancestral land and water due to rights, pollution, and over-extraction of water. They are normally excluded from decisions about water. Clean clothes, washing dishes, showering, drinking, and cooking are very hard without clean water. Instead of using their hard-earned wages on needs and priorities, they need to buy bottled water for these simple everyday tasks.

-Jessa

Human Impact: <https://theconversation.com/what-treating-kashechewan-evacuees-reveals-about-canadas-drinking-water-crisis-policy-failure-is-an-indigenous-health-issue-274402>

An example of human impact is the evacuation of 200 people from Kashechewan First Nation to Kingston, Ontario. This was due to an immediate clear. They have been displaced by another failure of their community's drinking water system. Canada's research shows that unsafe drinking water continues to enable many illnesses, mental distress, and evacuations in First Nations communities. First Nations communities are still receiving warnings about unsafe water due to "Boil Water" advisories. First Nations people are more likely to lack reliable running water. Water would be delivered to them in drums or buckets, but this still increases the risk of bacteria because they are difficult to disinfect consistently. Gastrointestinal illnesses have been the outcome of their unsafe water, and even taking a bath is limited because of skin conditions. Mental health effects now recognize that there is something called "Water Anxiety," where people are stressed or worried about whether the water is safe.

-Jessa

Future Report: A section for the 20-year prediction.<https://indigenousclimatehub.ca/2024/06/water-protectors-indigenous-led-initiatives-safeguarding-canadas-waterways-in-a-changing-climate/#:~:text=These%20efforts%20have%20achieved%20notable,Getty%20Images%2C%20Licensed%2C%20Unsplash>)

What future does Indigenous water rights have in 20 years? If we don't do anything now, Indigenous water rights in Nova Scotia and across Canada could continue to face serious problems in the next 20 years. Many Indigenous communities might still struggle to get reliable, clean drinking water. Pollution, climate change, and development could make water sources less safe and harder to protect. Governments may continue making decisions about water without fully including Indigenous communities. This could lead to more conflicts over land and water rights. Cultural traditions connected to water could also be affected if water sources become damaged. However, many indigenous leaders and communities are already fighting for stronger protections and recognition of their rights.

-Zankia

Two authors must contribute here.